

SENATE RESOLUTION 346

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Martha Carolyn Swanson Sundquist of Townsend.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Martha Carolyn Swanson Sundquist; and

WHEREAS, Martha Sundquist served as Tennessee's First Lady from 1995 to 2003 alongside her husband, Governor Don Sundquist, and was a beloved wife, mother, grandmother, and friend; and

WHEREAS, born on October 10, 1937, in Joliet, Illinois, Mrs. Sundquist was the daughter of Harry and Carolyn Swanson and grew up in Lemont, Illinois; she was a 1959 graduate of Augustana College in Rock Island, Illinois, where she discovered and fell in love with both red bud trees and her future husband, Don Sundquist; and

WHEREAS, the Sundquists were married in 1959 and went on to live in all three Grand Divisions of the State, making their home in Shelbyville, Memphis, Nashville, and, finally, Townsend; although neither of them was from Tennessee, they both adored their adopted home state; and

WHEREAS, in 1989, Martha Sundquist received a USO appointment by President Ronald Reagan to the Board of Governors for a three-year term; six years later, she would serve as First Lady of Tennessee, often expressing disbelief that a girl from Lemont, Illinois, could ever ascend to such a role—one that she carried out with her characteristic grace and kindness; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Sundquist channeled her deep love for the natural world into projects that included wildflower beautification of interstate highways; she was especially proud that the Martha Sundquist State Forest in Cocke County was named in her honor; and

WHEREAS, a woman of many passions, Martha Sundquist loved God, family, and friends, as well as playing golf, gardening, and working on jigsaw puzzles, and she always had a song for any occasion; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Sundquist was also deeply devoted to her family, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, she will be lovingly remembered by her children, Tania (David) Williamson, Andrea Jeannet, and Donald Kenneth "Deke" Sundquist, Jr.; grandchildren, Gabby Jeannet (Markos Daskalakis) and Alex Jeannet; and a host of Swanson, Beyerhelm, and Sundquist relatives; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her husband and her parents, Mrs. Sundquist was preceded in death by her sister and brother-in-law, Bea and Carl Beyerhelm, and her brother and sister-in-law, Paul and Analee Swanson; and

WHEREAS, Martha Sundquist leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this legislative body should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor the memory of former First Lady Martha Carolyn Swanson Sundquist, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mrs. Sundquist.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.